

for what reaction a set of features will elicit. And there is no accounting for taste, as they say. When shopping for a cellphone I always suggest fixing of ones budget first. This may seem tough, because there's always the desire to spend just another 2000 bucks, especially if there is something with a particularly desirous feature that is just beyond ones current budget. This rule, does not apply if you have already decided what features you want however.

Windows Mobile (WM) was designed with a stylus in mind and migrating to a finger-based interface without changing the underlying OS wasn't the best idea. There remain some actions that are virtually impossible to perform accurately and intuitively with a capacitive-touch interface. One of the first devices based on WM 6.5 is the HTC Touch HD 2, based on a 4.3-inch capacitive touch display with amazing internals like a 1 GHz Snapdragon CPU from Qualcomm. I feel WM 7.0 will be the real deal and probably as close the Apple iPhone in terms of a seamless interface as I'd like to see. That being said, another phone to watch out for is the Sony Ericsson XPERIA X10 – an Android-based device with a custom UI and ultra-snappy Snapdragon processor. Android is a wonderful, well thought out platform that competes well with WM in terms of features, usability and performance.

Let's get back to the present. I visited a couple of Tata Croma outlets in the area and was surprised to see the interest for the Nokia 5800 Xpress Music topping the list, according to what the attendants told me. It seems people like the idea of a music phone with a large touch-screen and decent camera. Having tested this phone, I can vouch for it's decent all-round performance. The price has fallen to the Rs. 13,500 mark and for this price it makes a good deal for someone looking for a feature loaded phone – GPS, Wi-Fi, large screen, 3.2 MP camera, inbuilt storage with expansion – this phone has it all. I didn't like the interface though – it's too quirky being a resistive touch display. This is my problem with the Nokia N97 as well – although feature-rich I feel Nokia got the interface dead wrong. The N97 is nicely priced though, it seems



Blackberry Bold 9000